Deutsche Bank
Research

Rating
Buy

Asia
China

Technology
Software & Services

Company
GDS Holdings Ltd

Reuters	Bloomberg	Exchange	Ticker
GDS.OQ	GDS US	NSM	GDS

Date
21 May 2026

Forecast Change

Price at 20 May 2026 (USD)	36.66
Price target - 12mth (USD)	50.00
52-week range (USD)	47.52 - 23.69
HANG SENG INDEX	25,651

Running with the bulls

Valuation & Risks

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Demand roaring back - GDS following it

1Q results were satisfactory, but the news was the company is joining the front of the AI build out stampede. The dominant theme in the 1Q26 call was capturing the "multi-year growth story" of AI. Management stated customers are planning gigawatt-scale deployments in single clusters, a significant increase in demand, with customers now planning future deployments on an "unprecedented scale", largely supported by the increasing availability of domestic AI chips.

To meet this demand, GDS has outlined a three-year business plan to invest CNY30bn to CNY50bn. The lower-end is not a surprise, given the market state and this year's CNY9bn guidance. But given the management tone we expect the it to come in at the mid-to-high end, so approximately double our 2027 and 2028 capex estimates.

Management says this will result in net debt/EBITDA rising to 5-6x, and our estimates suggest 5.1x peak in both 2027 and 2028 on an approximate CNY40bn investment program. If CNY50bn was spent that would suggest a 6.5x peak gearing multiple (which may indicate our adjusted EBITDA estimate is conservative). While not a massive gearing increase, this does represent a sharp pivot away from the degearing narrative that defined 2025. While this will shake out some investors, we expect the market to slowly warm to this change. Risk has become more elevated however, leaving the stock vulnerable to bad news - especially given the firm's inability to generate underlying net profits across its long life. We considered lifting our Beta estimate, but think 1.2x still feels about right for a highly geared infrastructure company.

Currently, the markets seems fairly early in the approximately USD3tn AI infrastructure build out that hyperscalers are planning globally through 2030, and China will be an important part of global AI server growth.

We see this as Phase III of the company's build out, with Phase I being its initial China push, and Day One being Phase II. This phase has a reasonable tailwind, but GDS is pushing into a part of the market dominated by heavyweights, including SOE competitors that are not known for ROIC maximization. But overall we expect the excess demand for AI infrastructure to create adequate returns. Additionally, the firm has the ability to recycle developments into its REIT.

Key changes			
TP	48.00 to 50.00	↑	4.2%
Op prof margin (FYE)	14.4 to 14.3	↓	-0.7%
Net profit (FYE)	3,500.8 to 3,615.3	↑	3.3%

Source: Deutsche Bank

Price/price relative

Performance (%)	1m	3m	12m
Absolute	-18.4	-18.7	32.9
HANG SENG INDEX	-2.7	-2.9	8.3

Source: Deutsche Bank

Key indicators (FY1)	
ROE (%)	13.1
Net debt/equity (%)	77.2
Book value/share (CNY)	154.67
Price/book (x)	1.6
Net interest cover (x)	1.2
Operating profit margin (%)	14.3

Source: Deutsche Bank

The scale of demand and its build out has led GDS to target 500 to 800 megawatts of new bookings annually, which is substantial relative to 1.9GW of capacity at quarter end. Year-to-date, the company has already secured over 340MW, indicating strong momentum towards its full-year 2026 target of at least 500MW. This compares to 300MW in 2025, which in turn was triple the recent annual run rate.

Results key points

Excluding one-offs, revenue for the quarter was up 8% YoY as was adjusted EBITDA (to CNY1,366m). Adjusting for the two China spin-offs; on a pro-forma basis revenue and adjusted EBITDA would have risen 12%. GDSreported a 1Q26 net profit of CNY2,624m, vs a CNY750m gain in 1Q25, with the positive results due to the gain from its Day One sell down.

The company lifted area utilized by 16k square meters QoQ, in line with recent quarters, and expects similar take up next quarter, before accelerating later in the year to get to 70k for the year, and then an expectation to approximately double that in 2027. Utilized area was up 13% YoY, even with the asset monetizations taking out 20k sq. m. Because of this, utilization remained stable at 75%.

DayOne value takes off

While the ongoing China upturn is good news, a major story in the last three months has been the value ramp-up at DayOne. IDC capacity in the region is tight, with mid-90% utlization in key Asian markets, and Middle East markets taking a reputation hit due to the Iran conflict. GDS's international business, DayOne, is widely reported to be seeking to raise USD4bn-USD5bn, while targeting a valuation near USD20bn, and its January sale was 6.5x its investment cost.

Figure 1: Funding rounds at DayOne - existing and potential

Date	Round	Capital raised (US$bn)	Equity value (US$bn)		GDS stake	
			Pre-money	Post-money	US$bn	%
2026*	IPO	5	15	20	3.6	17.9%
1/13/2026	Repurchase of US$385m shares at Series C price				2.2	23.9%
1/5/2026	Series C	2.0	7.4	9.4	2.6	28.0%
12/31/2024	Series B	1.2	2.5	3.7	1.3	35.6%
Early 2024	Series A	0.7	0.8	1.5	0.7	52.7%

** Estimated based on public information*

Source : Company release, Deutsche Bank estimates, Bloomberg Finance LP

Guidance and valuation

The company maintains guidance of revenue rising 8.5%-12.8% (CNY12,400-12,900), adjusted EBITDA rising 6.4%-11.0% (CNY5,750-6,000), and capex stepping up to CNY9.0bn. We think current prices for GDS have become more attractive, given the post results sell-off, and clearly strong demand, and we lift our DCF based target from USD48 to USD50 and retain our BUY rating (see page 4 for Valuation & Risk details).

Forecasts and ratios

Year End Dec 31	2024A	2025A	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales (CNYm)	10,322.1	11,432.3	12,711.5	14,797.0	18,891.8
EBITDA (CNYm)	4,395.0	4,964.8	5,471.5	6,292.4	7,835.6
Reported NPAT (CNYm)	-831.4	895.3	3,615.3	601.2	788.0
OLD DB EPS FD(CNY)	-4.51	-7.14	-6.17	1.32	6.54

% Change	-0.0%	-0.0%	-9.0%	-154.1%	-97.2%
DB EPS growth (%)	79.7	-58.5	21.4	87.3	–
Yield (net) (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

Source: Deutsche Bank estimates, company data

Quarterly financials

Figure 2: Results summary

Income Statement (CNY m)		1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	YoY	QoQ	Comment
Total revenue		**2,723**	**2,900**	**2,887**	**2,922**	**3,367**	**23.6%**	**15.2%**	Up 8% ex one-offs
Cost of sales		(1,222)	(1,355)	(1,387)	(1,424)	(1,404)	14.9%	-1.4%	
Selling and marketing		(33)	(34)	(40)	(42)	(37)	11.6%	-13.8%	
General and admin		(239)	(232)	(228)	(199)	(177)	-25.7%	-10.9%	
Research and development		(8)	(9)	(8)	(8)	(10)	21.2%	23.7%	
EBITDA		**1,222**	**1,271**	**1,223**	**1,248**	**1,740**	**42.4%**	**39.3%**	Up 8% ex one-offs
Adj EBITDA		1,324	1,372	1,342	1,366	1,949	47.2%	42.7%	
Adj gross profit		1,455	1,510	1,473	1,478	1,952	34.1%	32.1%	
Deprn & Amort		(857)	(857)	(861)	(885)	(832)	-2.9%	-6.0%	
Operating profit		**365**	**415**	**362**	**363**	**908**	**148.6%**	**149.9%**	
Others inc. asset sales		1,068	11	1,385	(1,621)	96	-91.0%	-105.9%	
EBIT		**1,433**	**425**	**1,747**	**(1,257)**	**1,004**	**-29.9%**	**-179.9%**	
EBIT margin		52.6%	14.7%	60.5%	-43.0%	29.8%			
Finance costs		(441)	(405)	(375)	(413)	(380)	-14.0%	-8.0%	
Associates		(28)	(26)	(461)	1,231	2,137			DayOne disposal gains
Taxation		(200)	(65)	(182)	(23)	(109)	-45.6%	366.9%	
Minority interest, preferred div		(15)	(15)	(16)	(18)	(28)	92.7%	56.5%	
Net Profit Attributable		**750**	**(86)**	**712**	**(481)**	**2,624**	**250.1%**	**-646.0%**	
Revenue		**2,723**	**2,900**	**2,887**	**2,922**	**3,367**	**23.6%**	**15.2%**	
Adjusted EBITDA		**1,324**	**1,372**	**1,342**	**1,366**	**1,949**	**47.2%**	**42.7%**	
Area under construction/acq.	sqm	132,208	132,235	72,764	73,994	118,411	-10.4%	60.0%	
Area in service	sqm	610,685	618,060	653,762	668,283	674,269	10.4%	0.9%	
Total capacity	sqm	742,893	750,295	726,526	742,277	792,680	6.7%	6.8%	
Total area committed	sqm	649,561	663,959	656,728	670,106	725,485	11.7%	8.3%	
Area utilized (EoP)	sqm	462,423	479,186	486,607	504,843	520,929	12.7%	3.2%	
Utilization	%	75.7%	77.5%	74.4%	75.5%	77.3%	1.5%	1.7%	
New area utilized	sqm	9,329	16,763	7,421	18,236	16,086	72.4%	-11.8%	
MSR (monthly service revenue)	Rmb/sqm	1,983	2,052	1,992	1,964	2,188	10.4%	11.4%	

Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

The China build out - and how to fund it

The acceleration in build out was evident in 4Q when the company announced plans to enter Inner Mongolia, Ningxia, and Shaoguan (in Northern Guangdong), each among the eight national computing hub nodes in China's "Eastern Data, Western Computing" policy. The policy focuses on moving hyperscaler activity to the West, while connecting the hubs with high-speed, high-capacity trunk capacity. The telcos built a lot of capacity in these more distant hubs, which made it difficult to profit, but demand is coming through, so GDS is ready to compete outside of its initial focus of in-and-around Tier 1 cities. The ramp-up already seems to be lined up, with GDS noting it has 3.7GW equivalent of land and power reservations.

Management noted that agreements getting signed commit to a certain capacity, which the company records as "bookings" while the rest of the site is reserved for the customer's subsequent growth, with follow-up orders over the next one-to-two years "almost certain". Over the last year the company has generated 1GW of bookings plus reservations, which given bookings over the last year would approximately suggest a 1:1 booking to reservation ratio. The company's 600MW of bookings (200,000 sq m) will mainly become billable in the next six to eight quarters.

Management noted a build out cost of around CNY20m per MW, and for that to drive around 10-11% adjusted gross profit yield (revenue less cash opex/ gross PP&E). We would assume the targeted utilization would be around 90% - but this was not stated. This compares to its current portfolio generating 11% at 75% utilization. The company provided such details, as MSR comes down along with development costs as more remote/ larger scale sites are built out. It was also noted that price per GW to build out has dropped around 15% in the last three years due to lower cost for mechanical & electrical plant.

The company plans to fund its build out using 60% debt funding. So at the CNY40bn mid-point of capex, that would mean CNY24bn of debt. It looks to fund the remaining CNY16bn of equity using a mix of CFO (last year CNY3bn), and asset monetizations.

The build-out is simplified following the company's raising of CNY3.5bn in 2025 from its China monetizations, and in the process creating a self-funding mechanism through its C-REIT. That REIT has been trading on a 3-4% dividend yield, yet the company can generate an IRR of low- to mid-teens pre-gearing, or in the 20s post gearing, making for a lucrative asset-development arbitrage - at least while the demand-supply situation is favourable - as it is now. The company aims to offload CNY4-6bn of assets in 2026, and received CNY2.7bn from a Day One sell-down in 1Q.

Valuation and earnings forecast changes

We cut our 2027 estimates sharply to reflect build out costs.

Figure 3: Earnings forecast changes

Annual	Reported			DB Estimates		DB prior est.		Variance		YoY change			DB vs. cons	
Key Revenue Metric	FY23	FY24	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	FY26E	FY27E
Operating Revenue	**9,957**	**10,322**	**11,432**	**12,711**	**14,797**	**12,711**	**15,101**	**0%**	**-2%**	***11%***	***11%***	***16%***	**0%**	**2%**
Cost and profitability														
Cost	5,882	5,927	6,467	7,240	8,505	7,227	8,457	0%	1%	9%	12%	17%		
EBITDA	**4,074**	**4,395**	**4,965**	**5,471**	**6,292**	**5,484**	**6,644**	**0%**	**-5%**	**13%**	**10%**	**15%**	**-7%**	**-5%**
EBITDA margin	40.9%	42.6%	43.4%	43.0%	42.5%	43.1%	44.0%	-0.2%	-3.3%	2%	-1%	-1%		
EBIT	**555**	**1,152**	**1,505**	**1,813**	**1,666**	**1,826**	**2,340**	**-1%**	**-29%**	**31%**	**20%**	**-8%**	**-1%**	**-16%**
Net Profit	**(4,344)**	**3,371**	**895**	**3,615**	**601**	**3,501**	**1,025**	**3%**	**-41%**	**-73%**	**304%**	**-83%**	**21%**	**-67%**

Source : DB estimates, Bloomberg Finance LP consensus, company releases

Key downside risks include: 1) Interest rates rising, lifting earnings pressure; 2) Over-investment tendencies returning; 3) Spot pricing declining; and 4) Bloomberg reported just before 2Q25 quarter's results that ST Telemedia is considering selling its 30% stake, and cut that to 27% in mid-September via a block trade. It is locked up for six months, and could find a buyer for the rest, but this is complicated by the firm's VIE structure and dual-class voting shares.

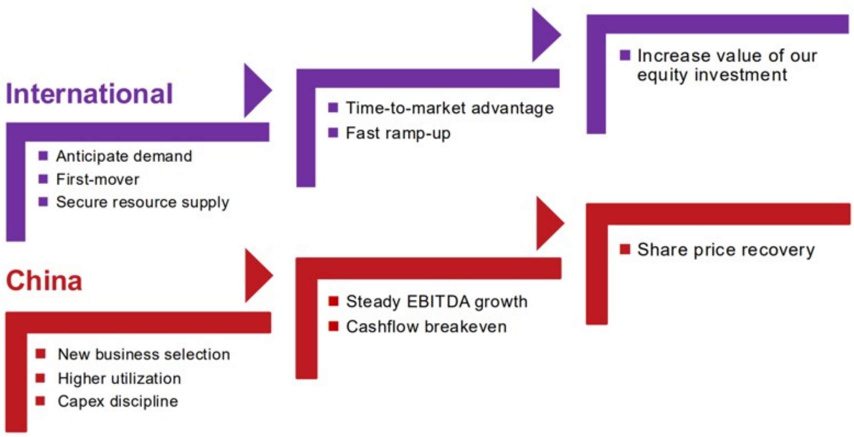
Figure 4: DCF estimates

DCF	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E	2031E	2032E	2033E	2034E	2035E
Risk free rate		2.0%		**Terminal growth estimate**							
Beta		1.20		inflation estimate			0.50%	RFR less term premium			
Mkt risk premium		6.0%		Discount for over-earning			0.0%	ROE-WACC partial convergence formula			
Cost of equity		9.2%		Productivity fade			-1.5%	Productivity-like return decay as IDCs age			
Interest post tax cost (LT money)		3.4%		**Terminal growth**			**-1.0%**				
Gearing (long term debt/ equity value)		20%									
WACC		8.0%									
Unlevered DCF (in USDm)											
Unlevered FCF		(29)	(1,350)	(996)	339	768	1,028	1,304	1,535	1,672	1,777
EV		**11,675**	**12,642**	**15,008**	**17,209**	**18,253**	**18,952**	**19,447**	**19,706**	**19,754**	**19,670**
Starting net debt (ex CBs)		(1,716)	(1,608)	(3,128)	(4,333)	(4,235)	(5,576)	(4,947)	(4,070)	(3,006)	(1,840)
Value of equity		**9,959**	**11,034**	**11,880**	**12,876**	**14,019**	**13,376**	**14,500**	**15,636**	**16,748**	**17,830**
Per share (HKD)		46.8	51.7	55.7	60.4	65.7	62.7	68.0	73.3	78.5	83.6
Per ADS (USD)		**48.0**	**53.1**	**57.1**	**61.9**	**67.4**	**64.3**	**69.7**	**75.2**	**80.5**	**85.7**
EV/EBITDA		14.9	14.1	13.4	12.2	10.9	10.1	9.2	8.5	8.0	7.5
DY at DCF value		0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	1.0%	1.2%	1.5%	1.8%	2.0%	2.1%
PE at DCF value		17.7	117.4	96.4	41.2	25.5	20.2	17.2	14.2	12.8	12.0

Source : Deutsche Bank estimates

Guidance and strategy

Figure 5: Strategic priorities



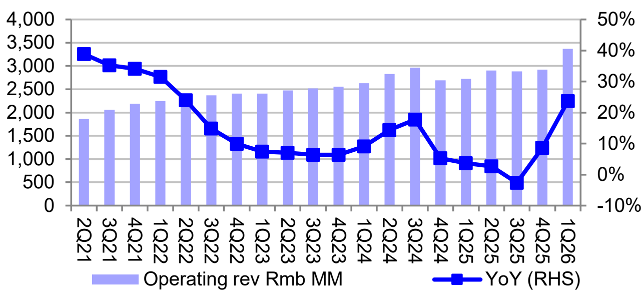
Source : 2Q24 company presentation

2026 guidance

- Revenue of CNY12,400m-12,900m (up 8.5-12.8%)
- Adjusted EBITDA of CNY5,750m-6,000m (up 6.4-11.0%)
- Capex of CNY9,000m

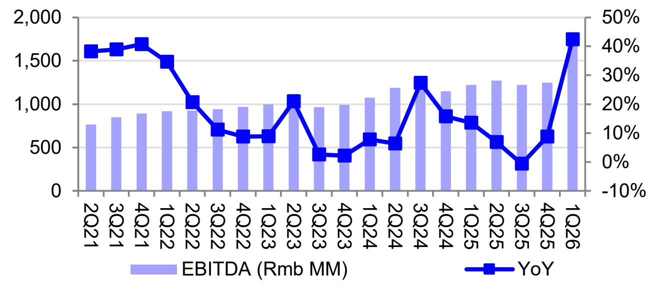
Quarterly charts

Figure 6: Total revenue



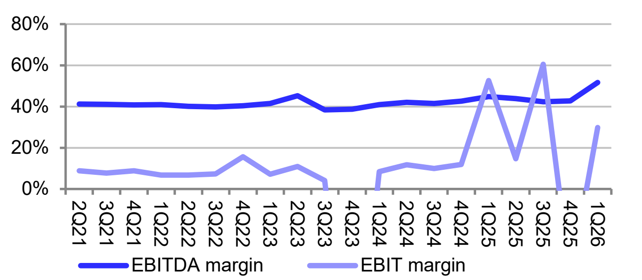
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 7: EBITDA



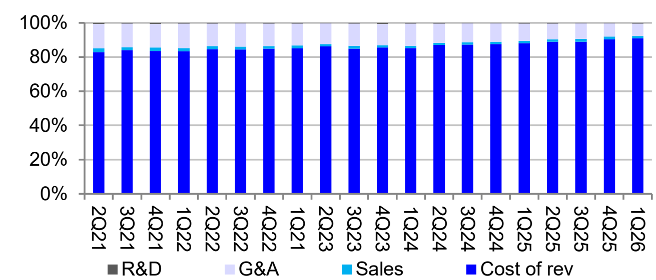
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 8: EBITDA/EBIT margins



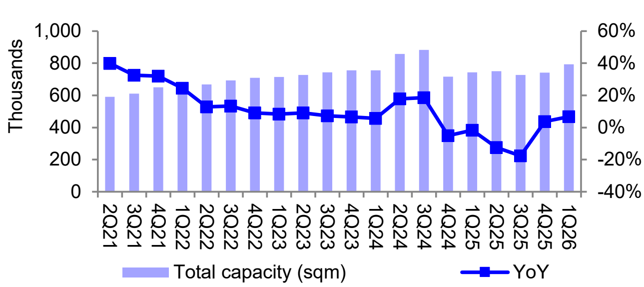
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 9: Opex breakdown



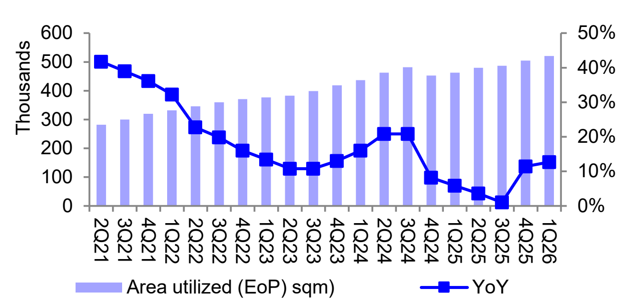
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 10: Total capacity



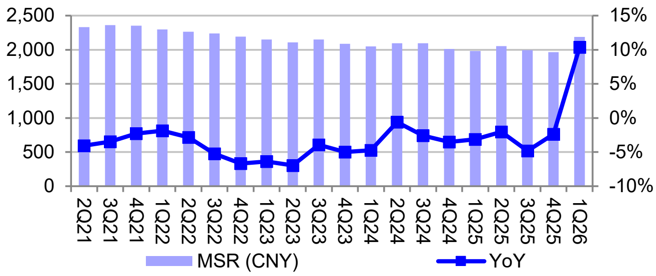
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 11: Area utilized



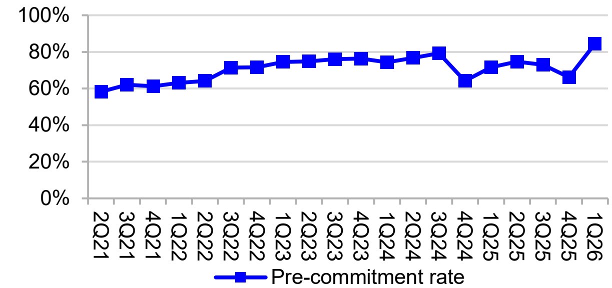
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 12: Monthly service revenue



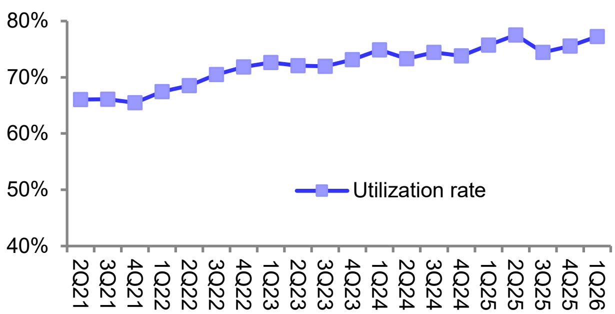
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 13: Pre-commitment rates



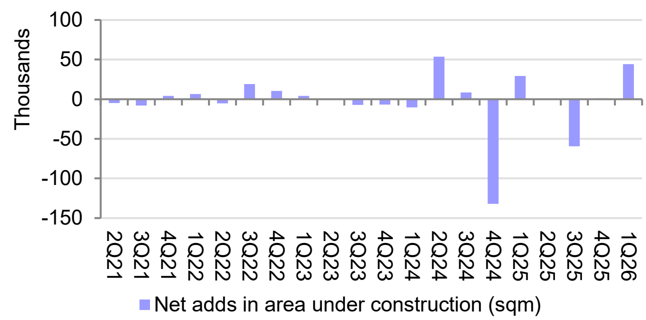
Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 14: Utilization rate



Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Figure 15: Net adds in area under construction



Source : Deutsche Bank, company data

Acknowledgement

We would like to thank Sylvia Chen of Evalueserve for her help in preparing this report.

Model updated: 21 May 2026

Running the numbers

Asia

China

Software & Services

GDS Holdings Ltd

Reuters: GDS.OQ   Bloomberg: GDS US

Buy

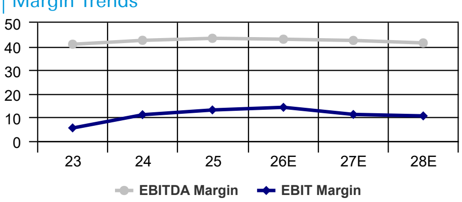
Price (20 May 26)	USD 36.66
Target Price	USD 50.00
52 Week range	USD 23.69 - 47.52
Market cap (m)	USDm 7,607.7 EURm 6,549.9

Company Profile

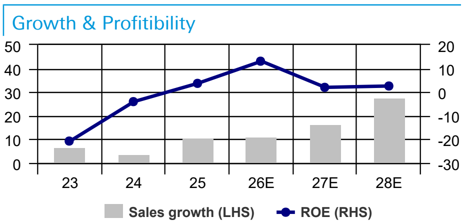
GDS is a leading independent developer and operator of data centers for the China market. It focuses on sites in the largest cities and serves hyperscale and other customers. It has a mixture of self-owned and leased sites and is starting to add data centers outside the mainland to support its customers' build outs.

Price Performance

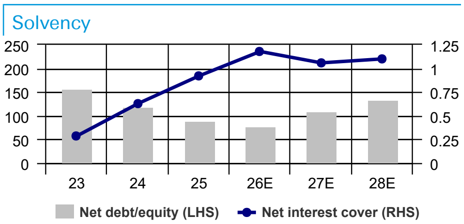
Margin Trends



Growth & Profitibility



Solvency



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Fiscal year end 31-Dec	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Financial Summary						
DB EPS (CNY)	-22.22	-4.51	-7.14	-5.61	-0.72	0.18
Reported EPS (CNY)	-22.22	-4.51	4.36	17.42	2.89	3.79
DPS (CNY)	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
BVPS (CNY)	101.1	120.2	135.7	154.7	157.8	162.0
Weighted average shares (m)	195	184	206	208	208	208
Average market cap (CNYm)	19,343	16,734	46,524	51,779	51,779	51,779
Enterprise value (CNYm)	49,772	43,821	71,575	76,083	86,739	95,182
Valuation Metrics						
P/E (DB) (x)	nm	nm	nm	nm	nm	nm
P/E (Reported) (x)	nm	nm	52.0	14.3	86.3	65.9
P/BV (x)	0.64	1.42	1.85	1.61	1.58	1.54
FCF Yield (%)	nm	13.8	nm	nm	nm	nm
Dividend Yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
EV/Sales (x)	5.0	4.2	6.3	6.0	5.9	5.0
EV/EBITDA (x)	12.2	10.0	14.4	13.9	13.8	12.1
EV/EBIT (x)	89.7	38.0	47.5	42.0	52.1	47.3
Income Statement (CNYm)						
Sales revenue	9,957	10,322	11,432	12,711	14,797	18,892
Gross profit	5,442	5,466	6,045	6,632	7,642	9,556
EBITDA	4,074	4,395	4,965	5,471	6,292	7,836
Depreciation	3,520	3,243	3,459	3,658	4,626	5,825
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT	555	1,152	1,505	1,813	1,666	2,010
Net interest income(expense)	-1,939	-1,835	-1,635	-1,538	-1,574	-1,827
Associates/affiliates	0	0	716	-41	111	229
Exceptionals/extraordinaries	0	0	2,364	4,780	750	750
Other pre-tax income/(expense)	-2,915	68	-1,522	1	1	1
Profit before tax	-4,300	-615	1,429	5,016	955	1,165
Income tax expense	-15	156	470	1,264	211	234
Minorities	5	6	10	10	10	10
Other post-tax income/(expense)	-54	-54	-54	-126	-133	-133
Net profit	-4,344	-831	895	3,615	601	788
DB adjustments (including dilution)	0	0	-2,364	-4,780	-750	-750
DB Net profit	-4,344	-831	-1,469	-1,165	-149	38
Cash Flow (CNYm)						
Cash flow from operations	-278	5,314	3,196	7,484	5,723	5,172
Net Capex	-6,326	-3,009	-4,706	-8,940	-16,437	-13,627
Free cash flow	-6,603	2,305	-1,510	-1,456	-10,714	-8,455
Equity raised/(bought back)	0	0	0	0	0	0
Dividends paid	0	0	0	0	0	0
Net inc/(dec) in borrowings	4,454	-3,151	3,635	200	6,837	5,200
Other investing/financing cash flows	-1,713	-7,723	-3,266	103	58	11
Net cash flow	-3,862	-8,569	-1,141	-1,153	-3,819	-3,243
Change in working capital	646	-1,208	-1,056	325	629	-1,271
Balance Sheet (CNYm)						
Cash and other liquid assets	7,711	7,868	14,306	15,262	11,454	8,220
Tangible fixed assets	47,499	40,204	38,054	43,451	55,394	63,366
Goodwill/intangible assets	7,765	6,367	5,461	5,461	5,461	5,461
Associates/investments	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other assets	11,471	19,209	22,178	23,549	25,264	27,772
Total assets	74,447	73,649	79,998	87,723	97,573	104,819
Interest bearing debt	37,975	34,824	38,459	38,659	45,496	50,696
Other liabilities	17,413	16,236	14,859	18,758	21,161	22,409
Total liabilities	55,388	51,061	53,318	57,418	66,657	73,105
Shareholders' equity	18,893	22,458	25,783	29,398	30,000	30,788
Minorities	166	130	897	907	917	927
Total shareholders' equity	19,059	22,588	26,680	30,305	30,916	31,714
Net debt	30,264	26,957	24,153	23,397	34,043	42,476
Key Company Metrics						
Sales growth (%)	6.8	3.7	10.8	11.2	16.4	27.7
DB EPS growth (%)	-185.6	79.7	-58.5	21.4	87.3	na
EBITDA Margin (%)	40.9	42.6	43.4	43.0	42.5	41.5
EBIT Margin (%)	5.6	11.2	13.2	14.3	11.3	10.6
Payout ratio (%)	nm	nm	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
ROE (%)	-20.7	-4.0	3.7	13.1	2.0	2.6
Capex/sales (%)	63.5	29.2	41.2	70.3	111.1	72.1
Capex/depreciation (x)	1.8	0.9	1.4	2.4	3.6	2.3
Net debt/equity (%)	158.8	119.3	90.5	77.2	110.1	133.9
Net interest cover (x)	0.3	0.6	0.9	1.2	1.1	1.1

Source: Company data, Deutsche Bank estimates

Appendix 1

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*Other information available upon request

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Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
GDS Holdings Ltd	GDS.OQ	36.66 (USD) 20 May 2026	NA

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Historical recommendations and target price: GDS Holdings Ltd (GDS.OQ)

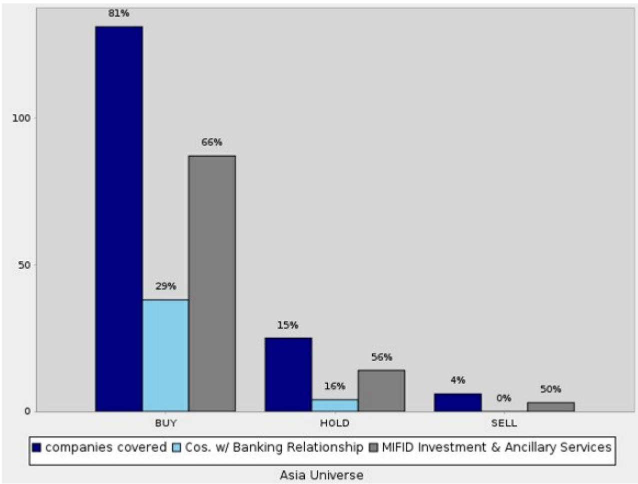
(as of 05/20/2026)

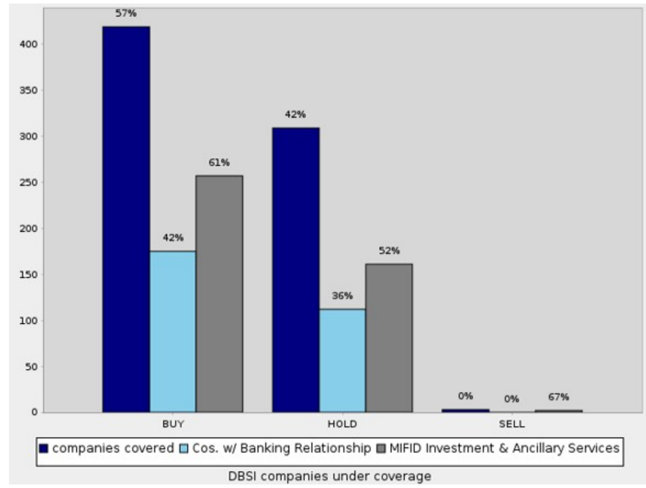
Current Recommendations
Buy
Hold
Sell
Not Rated
Suspended Rating

** Analyst is no longer at Deutsche Bank

1. 05/23/2024 Buy, Target Price Change USD 14.00, Current Price USD 7.81 Peter Milliken, CFA
2. 08/22/2024 Buy, Target Price Change USD 17.00, Current Price USD 16.30 Peter Milliken, CFA
3. 11/20/2024 Buy, Target Price Change USD 26.00, Current Price USD 18.57 Peter Milliken, CFA
4. 03/20/2025 Buy, Target Price Change USD 38.00, Current Price USD 28.62 Peter Milliken, CFA
5. 08/21/2025 Buy, Target Price Change USD 40.00, Current Price USD 32.00 Peter Milliken, CFA
6. 03/18/2026 Buy, Target Price Change USD 48.00, Current Price USD 44.49 Peter Milliken, CFA

Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships





Equity Rating and Dispersion Key

The Equity Rating Dispersion Chart depicts the following:

The proportion of recommendations that are rated "buy", "sell" and "hold" over the previous 12 months. This is shown for securities issued in the stated region e.g. "Europe Universe". See rating definitions below. This is represented by the "Companies Covered" bars in the chart. The percentage value displayed above the bar is the proportion as a percentage. E.g. 50% above the “buy” / “Companies Covered” bar means that 50% of DB’s equity research covered companies over the past 12 months have a “buy” rating.

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